

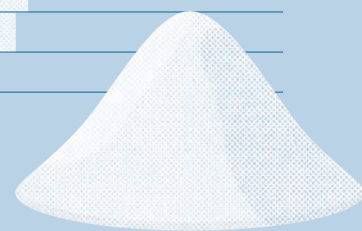
ONE SUGAR CUBE PER SERVING

Cerelac is the leading baby cereals brand worldwide. The products we examined contain an average of almost 4 grams of added sugar per serving. In countries where we were able to analyse the entire Cerelac range, the values presented correspond to the average added sugar content of the products. In the cases marked with an asterisk, we were only able to analyse one product and the value presented corresponds to its added sugar content.

Added sugar in Cerelac baby cereals in the main markets

Country	Added sugar content declared on the packaging	Products that contain added sugar	Added sugar per portion (in grammes)
Philippines	No	5 out of 8	7,3*
Nigeria	No	–	6,8*
Senegal	No	–	5,9*
Vietnam	No	7 out of 7	5,4*
Ethiopia	No	–	5,2*
South Africa	Yes	9 out of 9	4,2
Indonesia	Yes	13 out of 13	3,8
Bangladesh	Yes	9 out of 9	3,3
Thailand	Yes	5 out of 6	3,2
Brazil	No	6 out of 8	3,0
India	Yes	15 out of 15	2,7
Pakistan	No	8 out of 9	2,7*

Source: Public Eye and IBFAN (2024). Analysis of the nutritional information on the products or results of laboratory analyses when the sugar content is not declared.



Mucilon in the country) contain added sugar, on average 3 grams per serving.

“This is a big concern,” comments Rodrigo Viana, epidemiologist and Professor at the Department of Nutrition of the Federal University of Paraíba in Brazil. “Sugar should not be added to foods offered to babies and young children because it is unnecessary and highly addictive. Children get used to the sweet taste and start looking for more sugary foods, starting a negative cycle that increases the risk of nutrition-based disorders in adult life. These include obesity and other chronic non-communicable diseases, such as diabetes or high blood-pressure,” laments the expert.

“A form of colonization”

Although less pronounced, this trend is confirmed with the Nido brand, the most popular on the growing-up milks market. In 2022, global sales of Nido products for young children aged one to three had exceeded \$1 billion according to Euromonitor. We examined 29 of these products sold by Nestlé in some of the main markets

in low- and middle-income countries. The result: 21 of them (72 percent) contain added sugar.

For nine of these products, we were able to determine the amount of added sugar. On average, our analysis found almost two grams per serving. The maximum value – 5.3 grams per serving – was detected in a product sold in Panama.

With sales at around \$400 million in 2022, Indonesia is the world’s leading market for Nido, known locally as Dancow. The two products for children aged one and over sold in the country contain added sugar – more than 0.7 grams per serving.

While the multinational is quick to highlight that these products are “without added sucrose,” they do contain added sugar in the form of honey. However, honey and sucrose are both considered by the WHO as sugars that should not be added to baby food. Indeed, Nestlé itself explains it very well in an educational quiz on Nido’s website in South-Africa: replacing sucrose with honey has “no scientific health benefit”, as both can contribute “to weight gain and possibly obesity”.